

Destination: NextGen Internet



Faster, higher, better...does it end with broadband, or can we expect more from the Internet of tomorrow?

The World Wide Web has made a significant impact on our lives. A single mouse-click takes you to far off places. Every flight with the Internet has been a delightful experience right from accessing information to enjoying the wonders of the brilliant applications that have given the Internet their magical touch of interactivity, mind-boggling designs, zapping speeds and so much more.

But for anyone who uses the Internet frequently there are several frustrations related to Internet usage. These are primarily due to the lack of reliability of the connections. It is a little difficult to imagine how the much-touted broadband applications are going to turn out when you are having trouble getting a simple Web page to load on your PC. Forget that Pentium 4 CPU. What's really needed is a major upgrade of the

Internet infrastructure. Which brings us to the main question. What is the Internet going to look like in the foreseeable future?

The current Internet infrastructure is capable of carrying over a billion bits of data per second. While this might seem a lot at first glance, the rate at which Internet usage is currently increasing ensures that supply will soon outstrip demand.

So, what is expected of the next generation of the Internet? For most researchers who are working on the problem the wish list would include more bandwidth, greater reliability, always-on connectivity, integrated services and a single medium for the transfer of data, video or voice.

The connection?

At this point in time the highest connection speeds available to home-users in India are through DSL